Mountbatten felt that maybe the Maharaja was apprehensive because Kashmir would have no land link with prospective Indian territory, post the transfer of power. What could Nehru and Mountbatten do to catalyse the Maharaja from his state of nervous inertia?

Currently, all land routes connecting Kashmir to the Indian mainland, through parts of Punjab, were likely to fall in Pakistan. However, if the three eastern *tehsils* of Gurdaspur district were to be awarded to India by the Punjab Boundary Commission, then the accession of Jammu and Kashmir to India would be possible, provided the Maharaja cast his lot with India.



Image 4.3: Map of Gurdaspur's location
Source: Archives of AIM Television Pvt. Ltd.

On 8 August 1947, a provisional map was released by the Punjab Boundary Commission that showed the three eastern *tehsils* of Gurdaspur district falling under India, even with their major Muslim population.[18] On 12 August, the final award by the Punjab Boundary Commission was not only restricted to the three eastern *tehsils*, but India also got rewarded with